



A wild Google Pixel 6a appears

The Google Pixel 6a has been found to be listed on the FCC, sparking hopes of a market launch. <https://digit.in/may22-25>



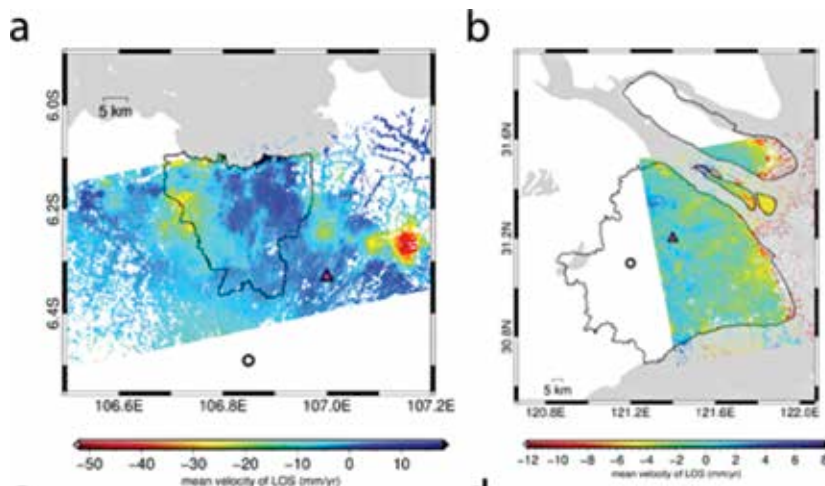
Meta's Horizon World market options

Meta has started testing tools to let creators monetise their creations in Horizon World. <https://digit.in/may22-26>

the subsequent rise in the water levels in major water bodies, making the water flow into our coastal cities. But this model would shift the focus of the problem closer to home because the reason for the subsidence has a much more direct correlation with irrational behaviour that we exhibit while using natural resources.

The main reason for the subsidence of coastal cities, as cited in this study, is the over-extraction of groundwater. We all know that groundwater is one of the primary water sources for humans, and its levels across the board are depleting due to overexploitation. But who thought that this would not only lead us to be left with lesser water, but also be the cause for the premature sinking of coastal cities.

To explain this problem, in the simplest of terms, we would need to understand the structure of the Earth's groundwater systems. If we take a cross-section of the Earth's surface, first we would have the surface, followed by the porous rock or soil layer, through which water seeps into the lower layers. The water that seeps is collected between this and the impermeable rock layer that is present below it. So, if the level of water goes down, it is natural for the soil and the rock layer above it to sink down. For a visual explanation of this, imagine a sachet of ketchup. When the ketchup is emptied out of the sachet, the outer packaging sinks and contracts, right? The same is happening in this case too. But,



Maps showing the subsidence velocity of Jakarta and Shanghai

here, the implication is twofold. Due to the reckless extraction of groundwater, we are not only minimising our groundwater resources but also bringing down the ground levels, causing the seawater in coastal cities to penetrate further into the land.

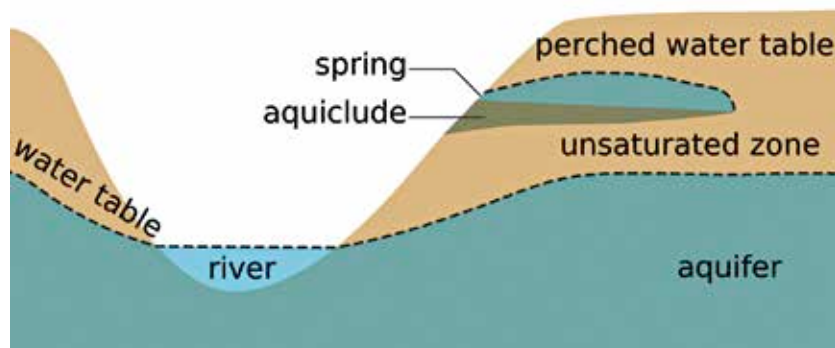
The question that must be circling in your minds would be that if this problem is so obvious and easy to understand, then why wasn't it in the spotlight until now? Well, the answer is simple and given in the research paper itself, "On a global scale, knowledge of coastal subsidence status is spatially and temporally limited". So, the researchers set out to fill the existing gaps in the knowledge about coastal subsidence, only to find out that things are going down faster than we had ever imagined. Literally.

The statistical findings are alarming! As per the data published

in this study, which we will discuss next, one of the cities from where this magazine's operations take place, Mumbai, would soon find itself submerged in the water from the Arabian sea!

According to the statistics published, in 33 of the 99 cities which were under study, the rate of subsidence was found to be equal to or more than 10mm/yr LOS (line-of-sight [LOS] displacement). This rate of subsidence, or in simpler words, sinking, is more or less five times faster than the rate at which the global mean sea level is rising. This rate was highest in the cities of Tianjin, Semarang, and Jakarta, where it stood at 30mm/yr LOS. You can access the complete table of cities and their data here: <https://digit.in/coastalcities>.

The authors of the study suggest that the stakeholders at the local level would need to step in to solve this issue. They wrote in the paper, "Continuous monitoring and policy intervention are required to reduce subsidence rates and minimise their consequences". They further go on to warn the governments and people of the regions, saying that if measures are not taken to fix the issue of subsidence, then, as we have continuously mentioned in this article, the cities of their region could be underwater much much sooner than they thought. **[1]**



Ground goes down, water comes in. Simple, yet deadly.